■■ How to Clear the Sample Data

Remove sample portfolio · Keep all formulas · Start fresh safely

P4 — TFSA · RRSP · RESP · Margin Tracker v2.0 · Read this BEFORE entering your own data

■ The One Rule That Protects Everything

■ **NEVER delete rows from any Portfolio tab, Dashboard, Dividend Tracker, or Settings tab. These tabs contain formulas that auto-populate from your Transaction Log. The ONLY tab you need to clear is the TRANSACTION LOG.**

■ **The Transaction Log is the ONLY tab with sample data you need to delete. Clear it properly and every other tab resets to zero automatically — instantly, with all formulas intact.**

The tracker uses a "single source of truth" architecture. Every number in every portfolio tab, dashboard, and tracker is a formula that reads from the Transaction Log. When you clear the Transaction Log data, every tab resets to zero on its own. You never need to touch any other tab.

■ Step-by-Step: How to Clear the Sample Data

1	**Make your copy first**	If you have not already: File → Make a copy. Give it your own name. Work ONLY from your personal copy — never the original template.
2	**Open the Transaction Log tab**	Click the "Transaction Log" tab at the bottom of the spreadsheet. This is the only tab you need to work in.
3	**Find the first data row**	Row 1 is the title header. Row 3 is the column headers (Date, Year, Account, Type...). Row 4 is where sample data begins. Click on cell A4.
4	**Select all sample data rows**	Click cell A4. Then press Ctrl+Shift+End (Windows) or Cmd+Shift+End (Mac) to select from A4 to the last row of data. This selects only the sample rows.
5	**Delete the data — NOT the rows**	Press the Delete key (or Backspace). This clears the cell contents. DO NOT right-click and choose "Delete rows" — that removes the rows entirely and can break dropdown validation.
6	**Verify everything reset**	Click the Main Dashboard tab. All values should now show $0.00 or be blank. All charts should show empty. All portfolio tabs should show no tickers. This confirms the formulas are working correctly.

7	**Fill in your Settings**	Go to Settings & Goals tab. Update the amber cells with your name, active year, TFSA/RRSP limits, RESP beneficiary names, and Margin rate.
8	**Start entering your transactions**	Go back to Transaction Log. Start entering YOUR real transactions in row 4 onwards. Every tab updates automatically as you type.

■ Every Tab — What to Clear vs What to Keep

Tab	Contains Sample Data?	Action Required	Why
Transaction Log	■ YES — sample rows 4+	DELETE rows 4+ contents only	This is the only source of real data
Main Dashboard	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Auto-resets when Transaction Log is cleared
TFSA Portfolio	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Reads from Transaction Log only
RRSP Portfolio	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Reads from Transaction Log only
RESP Portfolio	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Reads from Transaction Log only
RESP Tracker	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Reads from Transaction Log + Settings
Margin Portfolio	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Reads from Transaction Log only
Margin Interest Tracker	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Reads from Transaction Log only
Dividend Tracker	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Reads from Transaction Log only
Tax Dashboard	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Reads from Transaction Log only
Analysis & Reco	■ No — all formulas	Do nothing	Reads from all portfolio tabs
Settings & Goals	■ YES — sample settings	UPDATE amber cells only	Enter YOUR name, limits, RESP details, margin rate
Start Here	■ No — instructions	Read it once, then ignore	Reference guide — do not edit

■■ Common Mistakes — And How to Fix Them

I deleted the column header row (Row 3)	Press Ctrl+Z (Undo) immediately. If you cannot undo, go to File → Version History → See version history and restore a previous version. Row 3 contains the dropdown validation for Account and Type columns.
I right-clicked and chose "Delete rows" instead of pressing Delete	Undo immediately with Ctrl+Z. "Delete rows" removes the entire row including any hidden dropdown validation rules. Always press the Delete key only — never delete the rows themselves.

My portfolio tabs now show formula errors (#REF!, #N/A)	This usually means a header row was accidentally deleted. Go to File → Version History → restore the last good version. Then re-do your clearing steps — Delete key only, starting from row 4.
I edited a cell in a portfolio tab by mistake	Press Ctrl+Z immediately to undo. If you cannot undo, click on the cell and press Delete to remove whatever you typed. The formula should reappear. If the formula is gone, restore from Version History.
My charts are showing but the data is wrong	Live price data from GOOGLEFINANCE can take a few minutes to refresh. Wait 1–2 minutes and refresh the page. If charts still look wrong, check that Transaction Log data was fully cleared and no old sample rows remain below your new entries.
The Settings tab still shows sample names after I updated it	Make sure you are editing the amber cells only. The RESP Tracker, Dashboard, and RESP Portfolio pull names from the exact rows specified in Settings (B16 = Child 1 Name, B24 = Child 2 Name, etc.). Update the correct amber cells and the names will flow through automatically.

■ Your Safety Net — Google Sheets Version History

Google Sheets automatically saves every change you make. If something goes wrong, you can always go back to any previous version:

1	**Open Version History**	Click File → Version History → See version history
2	**Find the last good version**	A panel opens on the right showing all saves with timestamps. Look for the version just before you started clearing data.
3	**Preview it**	Click any version to preview what the sheet looked like at that point. The current sheet is unaffected while you browse.
4	**Restore it**	Click "Restore this version" to roll back. Your current version is also saved, so you can restore forward again if needed.

■ *Pro tip: Before clearing the sample data, name your version. Go to File → Version History → Name current version → type "Before clearing sample data". This creates a named restore point you can always find instantly.*

■ Pre-Entry Checklist — Before You Log Your First Transaction

- ■ Made a personal copy (File → Make a copy)
- ■ Renamed the copy with my name and year
- ■ Opened Transaction Log and selected rows 4 onwards

■	Pressed Delete key — NOT "Delete rows" — to clear sample data
■	Verified Main Dashboard shows $0.00 across all accounts
■	Updated Settings & Goals — name, year, TFSA/RRSP limits
■	Updated Settings — RESP beneficiary names and dates of birth
■	Updated Settings — Margin Rate and Tax Bracket
■	Read the Start Here tab for transaction entry rules
■	Ready to log my first real transaction in row 4 ■

■ *Once you complete this checklist you are fully set up. The tracker takes care of everything from here — just log your transactions and watch your portfolio build itself.*